TEXT ANALYSIS FOR DATA SCIENCE · RESEARCH POSTER

Trump, Iran & the language of conflict

Six rhetorical frames before, during, and after selected conflict dates

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Final snapshot · November 3, 2026

UCDP through September 30

Principal finding

Victory scores peak on event days.
Threat scores peak on event days.

Victory: 0.752 → 0.767 → 0.713 · Threat: 0.547 → 0.567 → 0.468

130	43	235	6
unique posts	conflict start dates	post / date pairs	rhetorical frames

01 Frame the project

Do rhetorical frames differ around conflict dates? Political posts mix threats, success claims, and negotiations. Comparing frames helps readers examine public messaging around selected events.

Task. Given an Iran-related post, assign six independent frame scores and compare the day before, day of, and day after an event's recorded start date.

02 Explain the workflow

1. **Collect & align**
   75 selected UCDP records; 43 start dates. Match original Iran-related posts by Eastern Time dates at −1, 0, +1 days.
2. **Prepare**
   Deduplicate by post ID; preserve saved text, case, and punctuation. One pair per post / event date.
3. **Represent & classify**
   BART tokenizer → contextual representations → `facebook/bart-large-mnli` . Six natural-language prompts; multi-label NLI; truncation enabled.
4. **Aggregate**
   Average scores within each date/window, then average those date means. Use every available post.

The model sees post text only. Headlines and fatalities do not enter the classifier. One post can score highly on several frames.

03 Show the results

Mean frame score by window

All six frames · same 0–1 scale

All available posts · 36 / 35 / 35 contributing dates · 76 / 77 / 82 post-event pairs (before / event day / after)

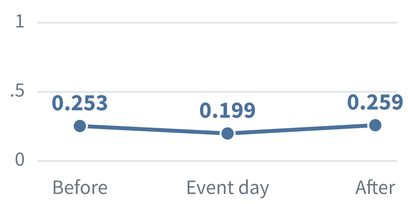
Threat



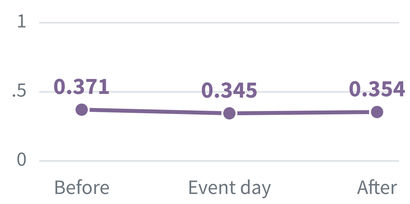
Victory



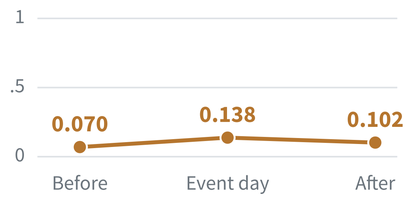
Diplomacy



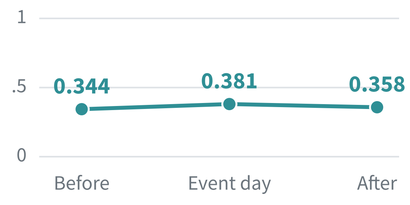
Ceasefire / Ending



Blame Allies



Media Criticism



Entailment scores, not calibrated probabilities or shares of posts. Lines connect window means; no uncertainty intervals are estimated. Different prompts can elicit different score levels.

04 Evaluate & reflect

Preliminary · human evaluation pending

Integrity checks passed. All 130 score IDs join to the corpus; six score columns are finite and in 0–1. Pairs are unique; saved date offsets match.

Accuracy is untested. No human gold labels, held-out precision/recall/F1, or evaluated baseline. Integrity checks do not validate rhetorical accuracy.

A failure mode to investigate

A post praising a military operation scores highly on Ceasefire / Ending without explicitly saying the fighting has ended.

Ceasefire / Ending **0.802**

Inspect source ↗ · Qualitative case, not a gold label.

Limits & practical implications

Window coverage differs; missing posts are not zero rhetoric. Overlapping windows reuse posts and create dependence.

Same-day dates cannot establish ordering. Linked headlines, missing media, and truncation can distort attribution.

Use scores to find language for human review. Human validation and non-event comparisons are needed before stronger claims.

Inside the corpus

Truth Social · 130 matched posts · chronological excerpts, not a live feed

2026-02-28 · @realDonaldTrump · excerpt

Iran tried to interfere in 2020, 2024 elections to stop Trump, and now faces renewed war with United States:…

2026-02-28 · @realDonaldTrump · excerpt

Khamenei, one of the most evil people in History, is dead. This is not only Justice for the people of Iran, but for all Great Americans, and those people from many…

Sources & reproducibility. Project repository, data & notebook · UCDP · BART-MNLI · Matching public-post archive. Frozen Nov 3: UCDP Candidate 26.01.26.09; pinned post archive through Nov 3. Legacy model revision remains unpinned; 40 new scores use a pinned BART revision. UCDP: CC BY 4.0; underlying post rights remain with their owners.

AI-use statement. Sean directed the project. Codex helped refresh sources, reconcile event IDs, rebuild matches and figures, and verify the poster. BART scored 40 new texts with the same prompts; 90 matching legacy scores were retained. Human review and oral defense remain Sean's responsibility; see the repository for the fuller history.